COULSDON AMATEUR TRANSMITTING SOCIETY

CONSTITUTION AND RULES

1. The name of the society shall be the Coulsdon Amateur Transmitting Society.

2. The nominal meeting place of the society shall be, until further notice, St Swithun's Church Hall, Grovelands Road, Purley, Surrey. The Committee may vary the location of individual meetings if they deem it appropriate.

3. Meetings will take place on a monthly basis, normally on the second Monday in each month. The Committee may vary the date of individual meetings or organise additional meetings if they deem it appropriate, but always giving the maximum practicable notice to members.

4. The aims of the Society shall be: To promote and further interest in all facets of Amateur Radio and electronics, giving special encouragement wherever possible to beginners (of all ages) and at the same time providing for the more advanced amateur.

5. MEMBERSHIP

5.1 Membership of the Society shall not be limited by age or gender. Application for membership shall be made on a form obtainable from any Committee Member. Completed forms shall be submitted for consideration and subsequent acceptance or rejection by the Committee. No reason for the rejection of any application need be given.

5.2 A Life Membership may be conferred on any member or other person who, in the agreed opinion of the Committee, has rendered sustained meritorious service to the society or who is considered to be deserving of such an honour. Such conferment shall be made (if possible in person) at an Annual General Meeting of the society. No annual subscription shall be payable by a Life Member.

5.3 Any action contrary to the spirit of amateur radio shall be deemed to be a disqualification from membership. The decision of the Committee shall be final in all cases.

5.4 Each Member shall receive, either at monthly meetings, by post, or by electronic delivery, a copy of the monthly newsletter known as "CATS Whispers".

5.5 Current normal subscription rate shall be payable by applicants over 18 and under 65 years of age. Applicants over age 65 shall pay at 50% of the full rate. Applicants under age 18 shall be granted free membership until reaching the age of 18. A reduced membership subscription may be agreed by the committee on an individual basis for a member, or applicant for membership, demonstrating special circumstances.

5.6 A small charge may be levied at meetings at the discretion of the Committee. Payment may be required for tea etc. provided.

6. The amount of annual subscription for the succeeding year shall be determined by the Committee on advice from the treasurer, and announced at the AGM.

7. SOCIETY ADMINISTRATION

7.1 A general meeting will be held annually, normally in May of each year.

7.2 All the officers and Committee Members shall retire annually and seek re-election if they so desire.

8. OFFICERS OF THE SOCIETY

8.1 The Honorary Secretary and Honorary Treasurer shall be elected annually at the Annual General Meeting (AGM), each position requiring one nominator and one seconder. All must be fully paid up members.

8.2 The Secretary shall be responsible for the day-to-day administration of society matters, minute keeping, maintenance of society records, enquiries and liaison with the RSGB.

8.3 The Honorary Treasurer shall have control over the society funds and normal expenditure, subject to the instructions of the Committee. The treasurer shall prepare and maintain the financial records of the society and undertake payment of recurrent items such as licence fees, accommodation fees and insurance premiums.

8.4 The treasurer shall maintain a bank account on behalf of the society and a list of officers entitled to countersign cheques.

9. The Committee shall consist of three elected members in addition to the Honorary Secretary and Treasurer. Of these five, a minimum of three shall be licensed radio amateurs. All shall be elected at the AGM and must be fully paid up members of at least one year's standing. A vote shall be taken if there are more than five nominations, all members being entitled to vote.

10. A Chairman shall be elected from the above five Committee Members at the AGM by a vote of the newly-elected Committee. Subsequently the chairman will have a casting vote at all meetings. At any meeting at which the Chairman is absent, the duty of chairmanship of that meeting shall fall upon the Honorary Secretary or the Treasurer.

11. To ensure continuity of Society activity, the Committee shall be responsible for detailed programme planning up to and including the Ordinary Meeting in the third month following that in which it retires.

12. The Society shall remain affiliated to the Radio Society of Great Britain for so long as the Committee shall find such affiliation to be cost effective and in the interests of the society.

13. Third party insurance will be sought to indemnify against the risk of harm to persons or property inside and outside the Society, as a result of the Society's activities.

14. QUORUM AND EXTRAORDINARY MEETINGS

14.1 To safeguard the interests of the Society, it is required that unless a quorum of at least three Committee Members be in attendance at Committee Meetings, these meetings shall be considered inquorate and therefore null and void. Similarly unless a quorum exists of no less than 25% of the total membership at AGMs and other Extraordinary Meetings, these meetings shall be considered inquorate and therefore null and void. In this case a subsequent meeting shall be convened at which any number of Members present shall constitute a quorum.

14.2 An Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) may be called by the submission to the Committee of a demand signed by a proposer and seconded by not less than four other members which shall state clearly the matter to be discussed. On receipt of such a demand, the Committee shall convene an EGM at the next practicable regular meeting and at such a meeting, no other business than that specified on the meeting calling notice shall be discussed.

15. If an elected Committee member is unable to attend a Committee meeting on the agreed date, an apology for absence shall be made to the chairman or secretary, and recorded in the meeting minutes. Should any Committee member fail to attend three consecutive meetings without apology, the Committee shall be empowered on a vote, to discharge that member from Committee membership.

16. Additional Members may be co-opted to the Committee for special purposes of a temporary nature, as decided by the Committee.

17. These Rules may be amended at an AGM or Extraordinary General Meeting (EGM) if prior notice is given to members of such intention, or, in an emergency, by the Committee with immediate effect and subject to ratification by the Members at an AGM or EGM.

18. A copy of these Rules shall be available for inspection at any meeting.

19. The society's financial year shall end on the 31st October.

20. AGM RESOLUTIONS AND NOMINATIONS

20.1 Resolutions to be put before the AGM shall be in writing, signed by the proposer and a seconder, and sent to the Secretary at least one calendar month before the meeting.

20.2 Nominations for Officers and Committee Members must be submitted before the opening of the meeting.

21. SUBSCRIPTIONS AND WINDING UP

21.1 The annual rate of subscription shall be decided by the Committee and shall fall due on the 1st June each year but shall be payable from the date of the AGM. Applicants accepted into membership after 31st December in a membership year may pay a subscription of half the appropriate rate for that year.

21.2 Members who have not paid their subscription by 1st June, i.e. who have not renewed their membership, shall be allowed two months grace. This means that they will continue to be regarded as full members but reminders that subscriptions are due on the 1st June shall appear in the preceding May and in the subsequent June and July Newsletters.

21.3 Memberships not renewed by the end of July shall lapse with effect from 1st August.

21.4 A lapsed Member may be reinstated on payment of his or her full normal annual subscription plus a reinstatement fee, the amount of which shall be determined by the Committee and reviewed by it from time to time, as is the annual subscription rate. Reinstatement fees may be waived in special cases, e.g. of protracted incapacitating illness or of protracted absence from the UK.

21.5 A proposal to wind up the society can only be made at an Extraordinary General Meeting called for that purpose.

SOCIETY PROPERTY & ASSETS

21.3 In the event of the winding up of the Society, the assets shall be liquidated and the resulting proceeds distributed on a pro-rata basis to the existing fully paid-up Members of at least five years standing.

23. CAPITAL EQUIPMENT

23.1 The society may purchase items to assist in the furtherance of the aims stated in Rule 4, with each purchase of capital equipment being agreed by a majority vote of the Committee.

23.2 An inventory of society assets shall be maintained and it shall be the responsibility of the secretary to maintain the inventory which shall record the nature of each item, identifying marks e.g. serial numbers where possible, the current monetary value as indicated by the treasurer and the current location of each item registered. This inventory shall be available for inspection to all members.

24. VALUATION AND DEPRECIATION

24.1 Each item owned by the society shall have a monetary value assigned for accounting purposes that may be the purchase price if new, or a market value if the item is second hand when acquired.

24.2 Depreciation on each item of society property shall be calculated annually by the treasurer in accordance with normal accounting practices.

25. LOANS OF SOCIETY PROPERTY

25.1 All current members of the society may request the loan of items of society-owned property for personal use. Loans will normally be for a period of three months but may be extended in three-month increments or some shorter period at the discretion of the Committee. Reasons to request a loan may include, but are not limited to: to perform tests or experiments with types of equipment that the member does not have available, to test or verify that the equipment is serviceable, to maintain the serviceability of items or to gain experience with items of amateur radio equipment. Particular consideration shall be given to the use of society equipment to encourage new entrants to amateur radio. In all cases, approval for loans shall only be given by the Committee.

25.2 Applications for the loan of society property shall be made through the secretary for consideration and approval by the Committee.

26. CONDITIONS OF LOAN

26.1 All loaned items shall be signed for by the recipient who will, as a condition of the loan, agree to indemnify the society to the value of the items loaned, against loss or damage while the equipment is in the borrower's possession.

26.2 Proof of the borrower's current address is to be supplied as a condition of loan, and any subsequent change must be notified to the society.

DOCUMENT HISTORY

Date	Amendment
December 1995	Reprinted with amendments up to and including that agreed to Rule 17 at the 1995 AGM.
October 2000	Transferred to files available to computers and Word-Processors.
February 2001	Extensive revisions.
November 2006	DRAFT — Revised and Rules 5.2, 14 & 23–26 added.
December 2006	Amendments and additions in Committee; final draft approved.
December 2006	Adopted at the 2006 AGM with minor typographical amendments.
December 2009	Amendments to Rules 5.5 and 21.1 added as agreed at the 2009 AGM.
May 2013	Amendments to Rules 2, 3 and 14.1 as agreed at the 2013 EGM.
May 2021	Amendments to Rules 18 (which also affect Rules 7.1, 21.2, 21.3, and 9) as agreed at the 2021 EGM.